

A collection of playing cards is displayed. In the foreground, a hand of 10 cards is fanned out, showing the Ace of Clubs, King of Clubs, Queen of Clubs, 9 of Diamonds, 8 of Diamonds, 6 of Spades, 5 of Spades, 3 of Spades, 2 of Spades, and the Ace of Hearts. Behind this fan, several other cards are laid out: a vertical stack of the Ace of Diamonds and 3 of Diamonds; a vertical stack of the Ace of Spades, 10 of Spades, 7 of Spades, and 5 of Spades; and a vertical stack of the 8 of Hearts and 8 of Diamonds. To the left of the fan, a vertical stack of cards shows the 9 of Clubs, 7 of Clubs, 6 of Clubs, 4 of Clubs, and 2 of Clubs. The cards are set against a plain white background.

Count Sure Winners				
				Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

A collection of playing cards. In the background, four cards are displayed vertically: a 9 of Clubs, a 10 of Diamonds, a 6 of Spades, and a King of Hearts. In the foreground, a fan of cards is shown, starting with the King of Clubs on the left and fanning out to include the Queen of Clubs, 3 of Clubs, 2 of Diamonds, Ace of Diamonds, 7 of Diamonds, King of Spades, Ace of Spades, 7 of Spades, 5 of Spades, Ace of Hearts, 6 of Hearts, and a single red heart symbol on the far right.

Count Sure Winners				
				Total

Decide How to Develop Winners			
Promotion	Length	Finesse	End Play

Board: 2

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 7NT

Declarer: North

Board: 4

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: East

Board 2

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 8 4
 ♥ Q J 9 7 6 4
 ♦ J 10 2
 ♣ 8

♠ K Q 6 3
 ♥ A K
 ♦ K Q 9
 ♣ A K Q 5



♠ 2
 ♥ 10 5 3 2
 ♦ 8 7 6 5 4
 ♣ J 10 3

♠ A J 10 7 5
 ♥ 8
 ♦ A 3
 ♣ 9 7 6 4 2

West	North	East	South
	2♣	Pass	2♠
Pass	4NT	Pass	5♥
Pass	7NT		
All Pass			
7NT by North			

You dealt this hand.

With 26 points you open 2♣. Partner responds 2♠.

Partner has 8+ points and a good 5-card ♠ suit. You are absolutely sure you will go to slam, and right now the only thing you want to know is how many Aces are in partner's hand. So you use Blackwood 4NT. Partner answers 5♥. What is your bid?

Obviously you could bid 7♠. But in fact you can count that there will be thirteen top tricks without a ruff; 5 ♠s, 2 ♥s, 3 ♦s and 3 ♣s. So you might as well bid 7NT. (By the way, the people who bid 7♠ got the opening ♣ lead ruffed!)

Board 4

East Deals

Both Vul

♠ 6 3
 ♥ K Q J 10 2
 ♦ 10 9 6
 ♣ 9 8 4

♠ J 10 9 2

♥ 8 4 3

♦ K J 3 2

♣ 10 6



♠ A K Q 7 5

♥ A 6

♦ A Q 7

♣ K Q 3

♠ 8 4

♥ 9 7 5

♦ 8 5 4

♣ A J 7 5 2

*West**North**East**South*

2♦

Pass

2♠

Pass

3♥

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by East

With one more point you could have made a positive response. Instead, you bid 2♦. Partner now bids 2♠. What is your bid?

Not being in love with partner's ♠s, you have enough strength to now bid 3♥. Partner replies 3NT.

When you have nothing more to say, you pass.